



Naafiri Mid

A personalized guide for **soup minion#NA1** · Patch 26.13 · July 2026

Every claim in this guide is labeled. **VERIFIED** = confirmed by 3-vote adversarial fact-checking across independent sources. **SINGLE SOURCE** = one reputable source, unverified elsewhere. **REASONING** = derived from current-patch numbers (Riot Data Dragon 16.13.1) + game knowledge; sanity-check in the practice tool. **YOUR DATA** = from your own match history (59 Naafiri games, season 2026).

The One-Paragraph Diagnosis

YOUR DATA You are already **good** at Naafiri mid: 62% win rate this season (66% over the last 7 days), 9.5 kills a game, solid damage. Your account sits at Gold 3 because of two leaks, and neither is mechanical: **kill participation of ~43%** (8 of 28 ranked losses at $KP \leq 32\%$, including two 0% games), and losses that end at **~27 minutes** — *faster than your wins*. You are not falling off late; you are farming while the map decides the game. Nearly everything in this guide funnels toward one skill: **converting your lane advantage into map presence between minutes 8 and 25**. Fix that and this champion carries you to Platinum — you've already peaked at Plat 2 this season.

1 • The Kit, As A Fighting Game

VERIFIED Ability facts below confirmed against the LoL Wiki and Riot's Data Dragon API for patch 26.13. Fun fossil: the 25.06 midscope swapped W and R, and the API still shows it — the ultimate's internal ID is literally NaafiriW.



Passive — We Are More

Packmates spawn and attack whatever you attack. They're your damage multiplier and your Deathfire Touch applicator. They die to AoE — vs mages, they're also your skillshot shields.



Q — Darkin Daggers (9-7s CD, starts after 2nd cast)

Two casts. Q1 applies a bleed; Q2 detonates remaining bleed damage with a bonus that scales off missing health, and **heals you against champions**. The cooldown doesn't start until Q2 (or the 4s recast window lapses).

FGC translation: Q1 is your fireball — it's the poke and the conditioning tool. Q1 hit → Q2 is your **confirm**; treat the two as one input the way you'd never drop a combo after a stray hit. Your self-reported "missing Q" problem is a whiff-punish problem: you're throwing Q1 raw at neutral. Throw it when their movement is committed — as they step up to last-hit, during their cast animation, or after you've conditioned a dodge direction with two same-side throws (then aim at the dodge). A whiffed Q1 means your entire offense is on cooldown: back off like you just whiffed a DP.



W — The Call of the Pack (26-18s CD)

Summons extra packmates, empowers the pack, and starts a "hunt" window. **It has no takedown reset** — the 25.06 rework removed that explicitly (its one R interaction: casting R extends the hunt by 1.75s). Use it as your all-in steroid, cast *before* you commit so the extra hounds join the full route.



E — Eviscerate (11-7s CD, 450 range dash)

Dash + AoE damage in two hits. It's your gap-closer *and* your only defensive tool.

FGC translation: E is a resource like meter. Dashing in with E is spending your only movement option — if their answer (Zed R, Ahri charm, exhaust) is still up, you've jumped in on a shoto holding down-back. In poke lanes, **hold E to dodge the return skillshot** after you Q — that's your read-based sidestep. E used aggressively is a hard commit; E held is a reversal threat that changes how they play.



R — Hounds' Pursuit (110/95/80s CD, 900 range)

VERIFIED You were right: **the takedown reward lives on R**. Champion takedown within 7s of casting → a reveal pulse around Naafiri **and one free recast within 12s**; the recast also grants a 3s shield (100/150/200 + 150% bonus AD). This is the reset engine: kill one target, immediately have a shielded second engage. Stack it with Axiom Arc's ult-CD refund (also takedown-triggered) and a good fight gives you R → kill → free R → kill → half your ult CD already back.

FGC translation: the recast is your okizeme — the first kill isn't the end of the sequence, it's the knockdown. Before you press R the first time, already know who the *second* target is.

2 · Runes: An Honest Reality Check

VERIFIED What the current-patch data actually says about mid keystones (Emerald+, patch 26.13):

	Keystone	Status on Naafiri mid	Evidence
	Electrocute	Most-picked keystone	53.65% WR, 23.7k games (lolalytics)
	Hail of Blades	u.gg's recommended page (Domination + Sorcery: Transcendence/Scorch)	50.8% WR, 13.5k matches (u.gg)
	Deathfire Touch	Real, current, but a niche variant — u.gg lists it only as an alternate "AD" page (paired with Eclipse); Master-tier DFT VODs exist on 26.13	One u.gg sample: 43.2% WR, 3.1k games
	Dark Harvest	Third displayed option	lolalytics

VERIFIED **Deathfire Touch, precisely:** re-added in patch 26.9 (April 29, 2026) as a Sorcery keystone. Ability damage *or pet damage* burns for 1.5–6.53 (+3.5% bonus AD, +1.25% AP) magic damage per 0.5s tick; pet hits refresh a 1s burn, so your hounds keep it rolling constantly — that's the Naafiri hook. **But it was nerfed in 26.11:** damage changed from adaptive to *magic-only*, specifically to kill a Black Cleaver synergy. It's weaker for full-AD builds than when you first picked it up.

What this means for you **YOUR DATA**

You run DFT in 38 of 59 games at a personal 62% — you have made a niche page work, and it fits your poke-and-condition style perfectly. Nobody should tell you to drop a winning formula mid-streak. But the aggregate gap (DFT sample 43% vs Electrocute 53.65%) is large enough that it's probably not all sample noise. The experiment worth running: **20 games of Electrocute** — you already play it (14 games this season), and it's the lowest-friction switch: same Domination tree as your Electrocute page, same poke pattern, except your Q1 → packmate hits → Q2 *already procs it at range*. It rewards exactly the trade pattern you already run, but front-loads the damage instead of DoT-ing it. Keep DFT as your comfort pick into heavy-poke mirror lanes where the burn out-values burst.

Hail of Blades: the "how do I go in" problem **REASONING**

You said HoB feels stronger but you don't know how to use it in lane. That instinct is right — HoB is an **all-in keystone**, and the discomfort is because it demands a different game: it does nothing until you commit to autoattack range, which your poke style never enters on purpose.

Think of it as a **preplanned combo route off a conditioning read** — the throw after they've been conditioned to block. The route:

1. **Condition first (minutes 1-5):** poke with Q1 exactly as you do now. You're training them to respect the fireball and hold their dash/shield for it.
2. **The read:** when they're ~60% HP and their answer is down (they just used their dash/shield on a Q, or wasted it farming), that's the throw window.
3. **The route (drill 10 reps in practice tool until it's muscle memory):** W (pre-cast) → E in → **AA-AA-AA** (the three HoB autos — this is the part poke players skip) → Q1 → Q2 detonate → R if they flash. The three autos + pack hits are most of HoB's value; going in with abilities only wastes the keystone.
4. **Post-6:** the same route but R is the opener from 900 range, and a kill hands you the shielded recast — your escape is built into the confirm.

Adopt it in normals first. Until the AA-weave is automatic, HoB games will feel worse than DFT games — that's execution, not the keystone.

3 • Items

VERIFIED The standard 26.13 mid path — and the one you already build:

Slot	Item	Why
Start	 Doran's Blade	Your standard start; components: Serrated Dirk first back if you can afford it.
1	 Voltaic Cyclosword (3000g) or Hubris — see §4	Energized proc adds burst to every engage; 56.7% WR, and u.gg/Mobalytics both open with it.
Boots	 Gluttonous Greaves	Standard (both aggregators' path).
2	 Axiom Arc (2750g)	Ult CD refund on takedown — the other half of your reset engine. 60.1% WR at slot 3-4.
3	 Serylda's Grudge (3000g)	35% armor pen — the "bruisers become killable" item. Highest-sample 4th-slot pick (57.6% WR / 14.6k games).
4-5	 Edge of Night ·  Death's Dance ·  GA ·  Serpent's Fang	Situational — see §5.

Caveat the verifiers insisted on: 4th/5th-slot win rates are survivorship-biased (games that reach item 4 were already being won). They tell you what's standard, not what causes wins.

4 • Hubris vs Voltaic — The Actual Math

REASONING The research verified that both are played first (lolalytics' path opens Hubris, u.gg's opens Voltaic) but no source survived verification explaining *when*. Here's the reasoning from current-patch tooltips (Data Dragon 16.13.1):

	 Voltaic Cyclosword — 3000g	 Hubris — 2800g
Stats	55 AD, 10 lethality, 10 haste	55 AD, 18 lethality , 10 haste
Passive	Energized: ability hit → bonus current-HP physical damage + lethality for 4s. Unconditional — procs on every single engage.	Eminence: takedown → +12 AD (+3 per kill) for 90s. Conditional — literally zero passive value in a fight where nobody dies.

The trade you're making: Hubris is 200g cheaper and has more raw lethality on its stat line — its "lost kill power" is only the Energized proc. What the proc is worth: it's front-loaded burst attached to your *first* ability hit, i.e., it helps you kill someone from an even state. Hubris's passive only pays out *after* the first kill — it makes kill #2 through #5 faster, and with 90s duration it's really a "keep fighting every wave" tempo item.

Decision rule

Voltaic is the default. Buy Hubris over it only when takedowns are already guaranteed — you're 2–3 kills up before your first full item and the lane is unwinnable for them, or the enemy team is fighting you every wave. If you're rushing Hubris while *even*, you've bought an item whose passive needs kills to work, to get the kills it needs to work — circular, and why it's the snowball pivot, not the standard rush.

How much gold is "an item ahead"? Mid legends run 2750–3300g. A solo kill is 300g + ~2 waves the dead laner misses (~250–400g more in CS/XP swing) — call each clean solo kill a ~600g swing. So **roughly 3 uncontested solo kills ≈ one item of real advantage**, less if they were shutdowns against you. At 2–3 kills up by first back, you're more than half an item ahead — that's the Hubris window: it compounds a lead that already exists.

5 • Kill Thresholds by Item Spike

REASONING No quantified thresholds survived fact-checking (an open question even for the community), so treat this as a calibrated starting point and verify against your own games. Assumes you land the full route (both Q casts — that's the swing factor).

Your spike	Squishies (mages, ADCs, enchanters)	Bruisers/divers	Tanks
Dirk + Boots (lvl 6-8)	Kill at $\leq 60-70\%$ HP with full route + keystone; full-HP kill needs their misplay	Only with jungler help	No — don't try
Voltaic done (lvl 8-10)	Full-HP kill with R route — this is your license to play assassin	Trade, don't all-in; kill at $\leq 60\%$	No
+ Axiom Arc (2 items)	Kill through Flash (R recast catches the flash)	Killable at $\leq 75\%$ if you dodge their key spell with E	No
+ Serylda's (3 items)	Deleted on sight	Now real targets — 35% armor pen is exactly the anti-bruiser stat	Still no. Serylda's slow is for kiting them, not killing them

Calibrate it yourself (5 minutes, practice tool)

Load practice tool, set a dummy to 1800 HP / 60 armor (a mid-game ADC), run your full route with your actual build, watch the damage. Repeat at 2600 HP / 120 armor (a bruiser). Do this once per patch — you'll stop guessing in game. In game, the fast check is Tab: **their armor grew faster than your lethality → they've left your kill list; find a squishier target.** Naafiri's identity is punishing *isolated, squishy* targets (verified) — walking past the Renekton to touch the Lux is the whole champion.

6 · Laning: Your Poke Game, Sharpened

REASONING Your poke-until-under-tower pattern is genuinely correct for this kit — here's the structure around it:

- **The poke loop:** Q1 when their movement commits (last-hit windows are the reliable tell) → packmates apply pressure → hold E to dodge the answer → step back. With Electrocute, add one auto or E when Q1 lands and the proc chunks; with DFT, the bleed+burn does the chip for you.
- **Level 1-2:** Q at 1, E at 2. You win extended level-2 trades with the pack; most mids expect a passive Naafiri.
- **The all-in conversion:** your current pattern's known weakness — pokes them low, they hug tower, you never cash in, their jungler resets the lane. Once they're at your kill threshold (\$5), *commit or leave*: either run the full route under tower right as the wave tanks tower aggro, or — usually better — **shove and spend the advantage elsewhere** (\$7). Poke that never converts to a kill, a plate, or a roam is just noise.
- **Matchup archetypes** (no per-matchup data survived verification; principles only): vs **artillery mages**, your packmates eat skillshots and DFT-style patience wins — your comfort zone. vs **melee assassins** (Zed, Qiyana): whoever lands their opener wins; hold E strictly defensively pre-6, respect their 6 spike, this is the pure-reads matchup your FGC brain is built for. vs **bruisers/enchanted tops flexed mid**: poke freely, never all-in without Serylda's, shove and roam instead.

7 · Roaming — Your #1 Improvement Area

YOUR DATA 43% kill participation. Eight losses at KP ≤32%. Losses ending at 27 minutes. Read those three numbers together and the story is: **lane won, map lost**. This section is the guide's core.

SINGLE SOURCE The verified game plan (Mobalytics, 26.13): *start looking for roams after pushing the wave; roaming opens at level 6; play around your ultimate — look for kills whenever R is up; gank bot, then rotate to Dragon*.

REASONING The operating system around that:

The rule that fixes your KP

Every time your wave crashes into their tower, you owe the map a decision — roam, invade with your jungler, deep ward, or hard reset. Standing in lane waiting for the wave to bounce back is the 43%-KP habit. You have ~25 seconds of paid time-off per crash; spend it somewhere every single time, even if "somewhere" is just a river ward and a look at Dragon.

- **When to roam (green lights):** wave crashed or slow-pushing away from you · R up (your ganks are 900-range point-and-click — nearly unmissable) · a side lane is pushing toward their own tower (targets overextended) · an objective spawns within ~45s · enemy mid just backed or died.
- **When NOT to roam (red lights):** wave frozen against you (you donate 2 waves + plates) · R down and target has escapes · bot lane already dove under their tower. A failed roam costs more at your elo than a skipped one.
- **Route choice:** default **bot-side** — it's the verified line (gank bot → take Dragon), and a bot-lane kill converts into an objective immediately. Gank top mainly when Herald/void grubs are up or top is your only winning lane.
- **The Gold-elo cheat code:** supports walk the map alone in the mid game (verified: "capitalise on this to get yourself free kills"). A support face-checking river vision is a free 300g + a free objective for a champion with a 900-range targeted ult. Hunt wards; hunt the warder.

8 • Ahead But Can't Close — The Conversion Playbook

YOUR DATA Your words, and your match history agrees. The pattern in your losses isn't throwing fights — it's **kills that buy nothing**.

REASONING Kills are currency, not score. After every pick, in the 10 seconds while they're grey-screened, ask: **what did this kill just buy?** The menu, in order:

1. **An objective.** Dragon/Herald/Baron if numbers allow. This is the verified core loop (gank → rotate to Drake).
2. **A tower or plates.** Mid tower first — it opens the whole map for the pick game.
3. **Vision.** Sweep + deep ward their jungle entrances; the next pick comes from this darkness. (Picks before objectives is standard assassin macro.)
4. **A crashed wave somewhere.** Worst acceptable answer — never just recall on a kill with 40s of numbers advantage on the clock.

Mid-game plan when ahead (2+ items, 15-25 min)

SINGLE SOURCE Side-lane and pressure towers; punish lone supports and rotators; you "easily take down squishy champions in the mid game." **REASONING** Structure it as a loop: **push side wave → ward the flank → look mid for a pick with R up → objective on the pick → back to a side lane**. Each lap of that loop is 60–90 seconds and each one either gains map or gains gold. The failure mode in your losses is exiting the loop — farming a quiet side lane while the enemy groups 5 and takes mid. If the enemy grouped and you can't get a pick: **join your team immediately**. A 2-item Naafiri grouped is scarier than a 3-item Naafiri arriving after the fight.

- ☐ Win a fight at Dragon ≥ 3 spawns? Force the next fight *before* soul point, not at it.
- ☐ 5k+ gold lead at 20 min? Group mid, take tower, end by 28 — your champ's best window (she "falls off a bit" late, verified).
- ☐ Enemy has a fed carry? They are your only R target in every fight from now on.

9 • Teamfights — Stop Dying Going In

YOUR DATA Pain point #2, and it interlocks with the first: low-KP players arrive at fights late and enter them badly.

REASONING Assassin entry rules, FGC-flavored:

- **You are never the opener.** Entering first is jumping in on someone whose reversal is up. You enter on *whiffs*: the enemy's key CC (the hook, the Malphite R, the exhaust) just got used on someone else — that's your frame advantage; the route is now safe.
- **Flank, don't funnel.** R is 900 range and point-and-click: you don't need to walk through the frontline. Fight from a side bush or the fog. Your late-game role (verified): flank the enemy **but stick near teammates** — the flank angle without the solo-side-lane isolation.
- **Target selection is pre-decided:** squishiest reachable target, and the *next* one after it (the R recast needs a plan before the first cast). Never ult a full-HP bruiser "because he was closest" — check §5's threshold table.
- **The exit is built in:** kill → R recast with its 100–200 (+150% bAD) shield → that's your combo escape, either onto target #2 or *backward* to a packmate-covered retreat. If the kill isn't certain, you have no exit — don't press the button.
- **Item help if fights stay lethal:** Edge of Night's spell shield blocks the one ability (the hook, the snare) that usually kills you on entry — it most directly purchases what you're missing. Death's Dance/GA for 5th–

6th. **REASONING** — the statistical case for defensive items got *refuted* in verification (survivorship bias), so buy them for the specific problem, not the win rate: if you're dying to burst-on-entry, EoN; to sustained damage, Death's Dance; if you're so fed the game rests on you, GA. A full bruiser build (Eclipse/Cleaver/Sterak's) exists but had no verified evidence behind it — entry timing, not items, is the real fix at your rank.

10 · Game Plan by Stage — What Naafiri Wants

Stage	What she wants (verified skeleton, single-source)	Your specific focus
Early (0-8)	Farm, poke, survive to items; roams open at 6; play around R cooldown	Your best phase already — just convert poke into <i>something</i> (kill, plates, or a shove-roam) instead of letting it decay
Mid (8-25)	Her prime. Side-lane tower pressure, delete lone squishies/supports, picks with R up, rotate off kills to Dragon/Herald	The KP fix lives here. Run the \$8 loop; every wave-crash triggers a map decision
Late (25+)	"Falls off a bit as teams group." Grouped flanks near her team, punish rotations, one clean pick ends the game	Don't solo side-lane. One good R + recast on a carry <i>is</i> the win condition — play patient, like holding for one clean punish in round 3

11 · What Didn't Survive Fact-Checking

Full transparency on the limits of this guide's evidence:

- Kill-thresholds-per-item, the Hubris/Voltaic decision, and gold-lead-per-item had **no verified sources** — §4-5 are reasoning from current-patch data, labeled as such.
- The statistical case for defensive/bruiser items was **refuted** (survivorship bias in late-slot win rates).
- The per-stage game plan rests on **one source** (Mobalytics' 26.13 guide) — it matches standard assassin macro, but treat details as coaching advice, not law.
- onetricks.gg and the Reddit communities you suggested contributed no claims that survived verification this pass — worth browsing r/NaafiriMains yourself for HoB routes; nothing there met the evidence bar.
- All aggregate stats are Emerald+, patch 26.13, and will drift next patch.

Compiled 2026-07-04 by Claude for Campbell (soup minion#NA1) · Patch 26.13 · Sources: LoL Wiki, Riot patch notes 26.9/26.11, Riot Data Dragon 16.13.1, lolalytics, u.gg, Mobalytics, skill-capped; player data via op.gg/u.gg · 100-agent adversarially-verified research run + 104-agent jungle-role run · Images © Riot Games via Data Dragon CDN, used under Riot's Legal Jibber Jabber for non-commercial fan content.